

Tone User Guide

Tone

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Tone User Guide

A step-by-step walkthrough of everything in Tone, from your first sign-in to a published, on-brand draft.

1. Create your workspace

1. Open Tone and click **Start free** on the landing page.
2. Fill in your name, work email, password, company name, and industry. The industry field matters: it tailors how Tone frames every draft, and you can change it later in Settings.
3. Click **Create workspace**. You are the workspace **Owner** and land directly in the voice onboarding wizard.

Already have an account? Use **Sign in** instead.

2. Teach Tone your voice (the onboarding wizard)

This is the most important five minutes in the product. You do it once; Tone remembers forever.

Step 1 of 3 — Your writing. Name your first voice profile (for example “Company blog”), then paste 3 to 5 pieces of writing you are proud of: blog posts, emails, LinkedIn posts. Use **Add another sample** for more slots. At least one usable sample is required, but more samples mean a sharper voice.

Step 2 of 3 — Your website. Optionally add your website URL for extra brand context, then **Continue**.

Step 3 of 3 — Your voice. Dial in the personality:

- **Three tone sliders:** Formal vs Casual, Careful vs Bold, Concise vs Detailed.
- **Words you love:** comma-separated words to favor (for example “ship, momentum, craft”).
- **Words you ban:** words Tone must never use (for example “synergy, delve”).
- **Audience:** who you are writing for.
- **Competitors you do NOT want to sound like:** Tone actively steers away from their tone.

Click **Build my Voice Profile**. Tone distills your samples into voice traits (like “opinionated” or “dry humor”) and creates the profile. Click **Write something in your voice** to enter the workspace.

3. Find your way around the workspace

The app is a three-pane layout:

- **Left pane** — navigation (Write, Drafts, Voice profiles, Settings) plus your voice profiles, each with a circular **Voice Accuracy** ring. Click a profile to make it the active voice. The dot marks the active one.
- **Center pane** — the canvas where variations and your draft live.
- **Right pane** — the context panel: which profile you are writing as, the format picker, your brief, the generate button, and the live voice controls.

Top bar buttons, left to right:

- **Sidebar toggle** — collapse or reopen the left pane (hamburger menu on mobile).
- **Focus mode** (the crosshair icon) — hides both side panels for distraction-free writing. Click again to bring them back.
- **Density toggle** — switches between Comfortable and Compact spacing.
- **Theme toggle** — switches light and dark mode. Both preferences are saved to your account.

4. Generate your first draft

1. In the right panel, confirm **Writing as** shows the profile you want. The ring shows its current accuracy, and the chips below it show the learned voice traits.
2. Pick a **Format**: Blog post, LinkedIn post, Tweet, Email, or Landing copy.
3. Write a **Brief** — the topic, angle, and anything specific to include.
4. Click the sparkle button, ✨ **Generate on-voice drafts**. This is the “ideas” button: it always produces **three distinct takes side by side** — typically a Direct take, a Story-led take, and a Data-led take — all strictly in your brand voice.

5. Shape the output with the live voice controls

The **Voice controls (live)** box in the right panel works without leaving the page:

- Drag any of the three sliders (Formal–Casual, Careful–Bold, Concise–Detailed).
- Add **Emphasize keywords** to weave specific words in.

While the three variations are on screen, changing a control automatically re-shapes them in place after a moment. These are per-session overrides; they do not change the saved profile (edit that under Voice profiles).

6. Pick a variation and edit it

Each variation card has:

- 👍 / 👎 — quick feedback on whether that take was on-voice.
- **Edit this one** — loads it into the editor canvas.

In the editor you get a **format-true preview**: a tweet looks like a tweet with a character counter, an email shows its subject line and sender chrome, a LinkedIn post looks like a feed post, a blog post renders with headings, and landing copy shows labelled section blocks (Hero, Problem, Solution, Social proof, CTA).

Toolbar actions, all voice-aware:

- **Regenerate** — a fresh take on the same brief.
- **Shorten** — cuts roughly a third, keeping the strongest lines.
- **Expand** — adds substance, not fluff.
- **More on-brand** — pushes harder on your voice traits and do-words.

Switch to the **Edit** tab to type directly in the text. The **Variations** button takes you back to the three takes.

7. Close the loop with feedback (this is how Tone learns)

- 🗨️ tells the profile that output was off-voice.
- 👍 confirms it nailed the voice.
- 👍 **More like this** — the power move. If you edited the text first, your edited version is stored as a new training sample on the profile, tagged “learned from feedback”. The Voice Accuracy score recalculates immediately and you will see it climb in the toast and in the sidebar rings.

The more your team generates and reacts, the more accurate the profile gets. That accuracy is yours — it does not reset between sessions.

8. Save and manage drafts

1. Give the draft a title (or let Tone derive one from the brief) and click **Save draft**.
2. Open **Drafts** in the left nav to see everything, filterable by voice profile and status.
3. Move work through the pipeline with the status dropdown: **Draft** → **Approved** → **Published**.
4. Click any draft title to reopen it in the workspace with its brief, format, and voice profile attached. The trash icon deletes it.

9. Manage voice profiles

Under **Voice profiles**:

- **New profile** creates additional voices — for example “Company blog”, “Founder LinkedIn”, and “Support replies” can all live in one workspace and sound different.
- **View & tune** opens the full profile editor: rename it, adjust the default sliders, edit do/don’t words, audience, competitors, the learned voice traits (fix them if Tone got you wrong), and the website.
- **Writing samples** — add more samples anytime to raise accuracy; remove ones that no longer represent you. Samples learned from feedback appear here too.
- **Write with this** jumps straight to the workspace with that profile active.

10. Settings and your team

Open **Settings** from the left nav:

- **Appearance** — theme (Light / Dark / System) and density, saved per person.
- **Workspace** (Owner only) — company name, industry, and the **accent color** that brands the whole interface.
- **Team** (Owner manages) — invite teammates by name and email with a role:
 - **Owner** — everything, including workspace settings, members, and deletions.
 - **Editor** — generate, edit, tune profiles, and manage drafts.
 - **Viewer** — read-only access.

Inviting a brand-new user shows a one-time temporary password to share securely.

11. Quick tips

- Feed each profile at least three samples before judging its output.
- Ban your industry's cliché words early — it noticeably de-AI-ifies the output.
- Use one profile per surface (blog vs founder LinkedIn) rather than one catch-all voice.
- After a heavy edit you are happy with, always hit 👍 **More like this** — free training.
- Use Focus mode plus the Edit tab for long-form polishing sessions.